

OB2_Assignment 6_Final Memo

Start Assignment

- Due Sunday by 14:00
- Points 0
- Submitting a media recording



Unread Announcements

Final Memo: Video Memo

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Task Description

You are expected to create a video memo for the course with the purpose of giving you an opportunity to apply the [OrgDNA framework](https://learn.insead.edu/courses/9226/files/1057319?wrap=1) (<https://learn.insead.edu/courses/9226/files/1057319?wrap=1>)  (https://learn.insead.edu/courses/9226/files/1057319/download?download_frd=1) _ (<https://learn.insead.edu/courses/8656/files/997541/download>) and course concepts to analyze a specific management problem or leadership challenge in an organisation of your choice, and also a chance for you to practice your presentation and communication skills in a format that is common in organizations today.

Three basic parts of the video memo

1. Define and describe a specific business problem or leadership challenge.

Identify a legitimate business problem faced by an organization of your choice. Most students select an organization in which they have worked because they have privileged access and insight into its inner workings. Some choose organizations with well-documented challenges that can be analyzed using secondary data.

Choose a problem that is relatively recent—something the organization currently faces or has faced in the recent past. Be selective: insufficient information will not be accepted as an excuse for lack of depth.

The problem should be a *business problem*, not simply a “culture problem” or “structure problem.” By a business problem, we mean an issue reflecting some form of underperformance or failure to meet desired outcomes—whether in financial results, product development, service quality, or another area central to the organization’s mission.

While the business problem should not be purely about culture or structure, it should have identifiable roots in the organization’s DNA—its **architecture**, **culture**, or **power dynamics**. Avoid selecting problems driven primarily by flawed strategy or external market forces, as these will not be well suited to this assignment.

2. Analyze the business problem using the OrgDNA framework.

Examine how the organization’s architecture, culture, and/or influence systems contribute to the problem and serve as its root causes. After each class meeting, you will have a chance to reflect on how course concepts apply to your chosen problem; these reflections can serve as building blocks for your video memo as you see fit.

You do not need to analyze the problem through every component of the OrgDNA framework, nor should you rely on only one. Aim to incorporate a *broad enough range of concepts* to provide a well-rounded understanding of the organization’s dynamics, while going *deep enough* to avoid superficial analysis.

3. Develop recommendations.

Finally, **give your recommendations** about how to best address the issues you have identified. Note: Your recommendations must be clearly derived from your analysis, concrete, and actionable. They should flow logically based on your assessment of the issue and the tool(s) you use to

analyse it. You should also briefly spell out the implementation barriers and/or risks associated with your recommendations (“bullet-proofing”), and how to overcome / minimise them.

Sources of Information

You can gather information for your memo from one or more of the following sources:

- Your own direct experience
- People in the organisation through direct contact
- Data from the business press (e.g., Financial Times, Business Week, The Economist, Fortune, The Wall Street Journal, etc.)
- Reader-friendly management research journals (e.g., Academy of Management Executive, Harvard Business Review, Sloan Management Review, California Management Review etc.)
- Other secondary sources

Format and Submission of the video memo

Compile your problem articulation, analysis and recommendations into video memo as if presenting to a set of colleagues. Clearly articulate your business problem, the organizational root causes of the business problem, and your recommendations for change. You are encouraged to use slides or other visual aids to support your presentation.

There are a number of free software tools that you can use to create your video memo. For mac users, there is a native screen recording app: <https://support.apple.com/guide/mac-help/take-a-screenshot-mh26782/mac> (<https://support.apple.com/guide/mac-help/take-a-screenshot-mh26782/mac>). For windows users, a similar app: <https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/learning-center/how-to-record-screen-windows-11> (<https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/windows/learning-center/how-to-record-screen-windows-11>). You may also use commercial tools like Loom (<https://www.loom.com/> (<https://www.loom.com/>)). Note: these days technology changes fast, if you have come up with what you believe are better solutions, by all means please share your knowledge with your classmates and me.

Your video memo will be seen by me, a grader, as well as a small group of your classmates for the course final. No one else will have access to it. You may anonymize names or identifying details as you see fit.

Your video should be **8–12 minutes long**. Videos shorter than 8 minutes may lack sufficient depth; those longer than 12 minutes risk losing focus. Aim for concise, insightful analysis that clearly applies course frameworks to a real organizational situation.

Please upload your video memo onto the class website by the deadline specified above. If you face technological issues, please contact my assistant. Please name your file as follows: **[Section]_[FamilyName]_[FirstName]_MEMO**.

Evaluation Criteria of the video memo

Your grade will be based on the following:

- **Articulation of business problem (10%)**

A good score here will be based on a clear articulation of the problem supported by credible “data”. Data could include quantitative statistical data or qualitative anecdotal data. In addition, the problem articulation should clearly be a problem that reflects organizational underperformance rather than an organizational problem.

- **Analysis of your business problem using course concepts (50%)**

A good score here will be based on how well you use course concepts to effectively analyze your business problem. This is not meant to be a checklist exercise where you superficially refer to every course concept simply to check a box. It is better to apply two or three concepts thoughtfully than to mention many superficially. At the end of your analysis, the audience should have a clear sense of the organizational root cause(s) of your business problem.

- **Recommendations (40%)**

Recommendations should flow logically from the analysis and address the underlying causes of the problem. Discuss potential risks or unintended consequences and how you would mitigate them (“bullet-proofing”).

Accordingly, devote your time proportionally to each section: roughly 10% on defining the problem, 50% on analysis, and 40% on recommendations.

Additional Guidance on Video Memo

- Some students have asked me in the past if they can analyze a positively deviant business outcome and the organizational roots of this positive outcome. I will allow this but discourage it because 40% of the memo (and therefore your grade) will be comprised of your recommendations for how you would improve the situation. It will be harder to offer substantive recommendations if you are just analyzing a case where everything is going right.
- I encourage you to discuss your memo ideas with a classmate or study group before you start writing the memo to get feedback on whether the problem you are choosing is a good fit for the assignment and on how the OrgDNA framework can be leveraged to analyze the problem.
- To help you complete the memo, you will be tasked with 5 mini-reflections that will break down the memo into constituent parts and ask you to reflect on your business problem in light of each week's learnings. These reflections do not need to be more than a couple of paragraphs and are designed to help you incrementally make progress on your memo. To that end, these reflections will not be graded but will count towards your participation grade in the class.